

Git Init

Git Repository Basics

Learning objective

Initialize an existing project folder as a local Git repository.

Core idea

The **git init** command creates a hidden **.git** directory inside the current folder. This directory stores Git configuration, branches, commits, and history. The command works locally and does not upload the project to GitHub.

Expected output:

Initialized empty Git repository in /path/to/your-project/.git/

Commands to know

Command / pattern	Purpose
<code>git init</code>	Initialize the current folder
<code>git status</code>	Confirm that the repository is ready

Step-by-step workflow

- 1. Open a terminal in your project folder.
- 2. Run **git init**.
- 3. Read the confirmation message.
- 4. Run **git status** to verify the repository.

Common mistakes

- Running the command from the wrong folder.
- Deleting the hidden **.git** directory.
- Expecting **git init** to upload the project to GitHub.

Practice task

Create a folder named **git-init-practice**, enter it, run **git init**, and confirm the result with **git status**.

Quick check

What hidden directory is created after running `git init`?

Tip: Run `git status` before and after important Git commands so you can observe what changed.